EMNLP2026 BUDAPEST

HUFS-DILAB at WMT 2026 Automated Translation Quality Evaluation Task 1: Language-Pair Prompt Routing for Error Span Annotation

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Introduction

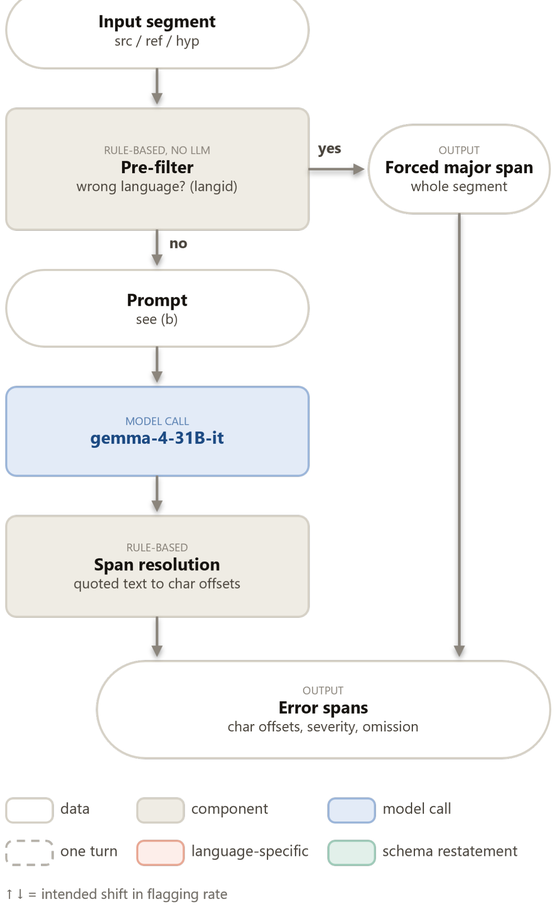
On task 1, segment-level error detection and span annotation, the automated system predicts error spans, severities, and omission of the given translation of MT system.

We investigate how far an off-the-shelf LLM can be taken as a judge: google/gemma-4-31b-it is prompted to annotate error spans, severities and omissions as constrained JSON given the source, the reference, and the translation. Each language pair is routed to a specialized prompt variant, which is motivated by the observation that, even with the same prompt, the judge shows different severity and error-density distributions across language pairs. To address these tendencies, we calibrate each prompt variant against human annotation where available. We also correct a rule-based wrong-language filter whose errors on closely related languages were silently overriding the judge's annotations.

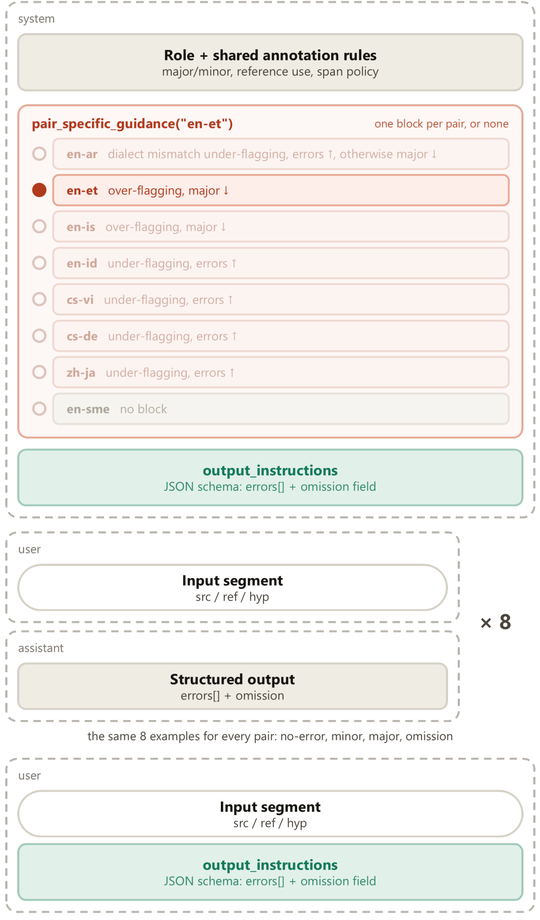
Pair	Deviation	Correction	ΔF1
major share, vs. validation			
en→ar	+20.1	dialect, *major* ↓	+1.6
en→et	+31.4	*major* ↓	+1.8
en→is	+22.3	*major* ↓	−0.3
error-free share, vs. other pairs			
zh→ja	+11.4	errors ↑	—
en→id	+9.8	errors ↑	—
cs→vi	+9.7	errors ↑	—
cs→de	+7.1	errors ↑	—

Observed language-pair dependence in severity annotation and error density. We treat these patterns as tendencies of the judge rather than effects of the data or system.

Our System



(a) Inference path.



(b) Prompt composition.

(a) A target segment first meets the wrong-language-prefilter. A translation in wrong language is treated as one segment-wide major span, with no judge model call.

(b) Every other segment goes into the composition of prompt, and the judge returns the list of error with severity, and omission field as constrained JSON.

(c) To counteract the judge's pair-dependent bias we adapt calibration blocks. Each block states the judge's desired behavior. The example of language-specific calibration prompt is stated below.

```
[en-ar]

scan carefully for register or dialect mismatches -- if the target uses
Modern Standard Arabic or a different dialect where the required Egyptian
Arabic form was expected , this is a real error even if the translation
otherwise reads fluently. Most defects found are minor ; reserve major for
genuine dialect mismatches or mistranslations that change meaning.
```

(c) EN-AR (Egyptian) calibration block.

Results

Language pair	Score	Rank
zh→ja	0.6500	1
cs→de	0.5663	2
cs→vi	0.5765	2
en→et	0.6086	3
en→is	0.6650	3
en→ar	0.5322	3
en→id	0.5502	3
en→sme	0.5343	—
Average	0.5854	

Rank shown on Codabench submission leaderboard

Rank	Cluster	Auto-evaluator	Underlying model	P	R	F1
1	1	Gemini-3.6-Flash*	Gemini 3.6 Flash	39.21	32.95	34.07
2	2	PhraseT1-01*	Gemini 3.5 Flash	34.73	36.34	33.47
3	2	fluencyscore-multispan-v2*	Gemini 3.5 Flash	40.39	31.39	33.46
4	2	fluencyscore-multispan-v2.1*	Gemini 3.5 Flash	40.27	31.44	33.46
5	3	gemma4-31b-v4ref-struct-best	Gemma 4 31B IT	33.79	36.04	32.85
6	4	Gemma 4 - thinking	Gemma 4 31B IT	30.89	39.03	32.58
7	5	Gemma 4	Gemma 4 31B IT	27.05	44.71	32.08
8	5	Gemma 4*	Gemma 4 31B IT	29.20	39.61	32.02
9	5	GPT-5.6 Sol - medium thinking*	GPT-5.6 Sol	28.45	40.65	31.98
10	6	Gemma 4 - thinking*	Gemma 4 31B IT	32.16	35.03	31.72
11	6	GPT-5.6 Terra*	GPT-5.6 Terra	31.37	34.79	31.50

Official rank stated in Findings of the WMT26 Shared Task on Automated Translation Quality Evaluation Systems: Compact Open Models are Competitive Quality Evaluators (Lavie et al., 2026).

Supported by Hankuk University of Foreign Studies Research Fund (2025) and the National Research Foundation of Korea (NRF), funded by the Korea government (MSIT), No. RS-2026-25602702.